

THE CONSUMER AWARENESS TRIBUNE

SPECIAL INVESTIGATIVE EDITION | EDUCATIONAL & AWARENESS PURPOSES ONLY

EXPOSED: THE LUNAR ASTRO SCAM ALLEGATIONS

An in-depth investigative report reveals allegations of digital fraud, bait-and-switch tactics, and intellectual property theft by Deepanshu Giri and the Lunar Astro platform.

Based on recent investigative reports and a surge of consumer complaints, Lunar Astro, an astrology platform founded by Deepanshu Giri, has come under heavy scrutiny. Accused of fraudulent practices, the platform allegedly prioritizes aggressive marketing and high-cost courses over accurate, personalized astrology services.

Consumers have raised alarms over what they describe as a calculated business model designed to exploit vulnerable individuals seeking spiritual and astrological guidance.

From exorbitant consultation fees to questionable academic credentials, the allegations paint a picture of a "GuruPreneur" leveraging digital marketing to manufacture a false reputation.

THE "SHADOW" TACTIC

Critics argue that Giri uses his engineering background to build a logical-sounding trap. By utilizing technical jargon, he makes spiritual claims feel "scientific," bypassing the critical

thinking of educated professionals who are in a vulnerable state (e.g., facing job loss or personal trauma).

This special report breaks down the key allegations, the financial traps, the discrepancies in lineage claims, and provides a comprehensive guide on how consumers can protect themselves from similar digital frauds in the belief-based economy.

"Desperation drives people to seek quick remedies through astrology. This desperation is a primary cause of fraud within the industry."

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KEY ALLEGATIONS & SCAM TACTICS

Bait-and-Switch Consultations

Clients reportedly pay premium fees—often exceeding ₹10,000—expecting a one-on-one consultation with Deepanshu Giri himself. Instead, consumer reports indicate they are assigned to inexperienced proxy students or junior staff operating under anonymous codes (e.g., #5007). Many users have reported that these paid consultations provided vague, generic, or inaccurate information, coupled with high costs for remedies that ultimately did not work.

Fabricated Reviews & SEO Manipulation

Lunar Astro is accused of using a tactic known as "domain flooding." By operating multiple websites (such as lunarastro.org, lunarastro.com, and consultlunarastro.com), the

organization attempts to dominate search engine results and bury negative feedback. Furthermore, they are accused of flooding platforms like Quora and Trustpilot with fake, self-praising reviews to manufacture a pristine online reputation.

Intellectual Property Theft

One of Giri's primary claims to authority is his "revolutionary" research. However, investigations and former colleagues claim that Deepanshu Giri stole the 'BCP' (Bhriugu Chakra Paddhati) technique from his teacher, Sunil John of Saptarishis Astrology. It is alleged that Giri rebranded this existing technique as his own original creation, "Paribhraman Paddhati," without providing proper attribution.

Intimidation of Critics & The "Troll Farm"

Victims who post negative reviews online have claimed to be targeted by coordinated mass-reporting of their

content. Complaints indicate that customers are harassed by a "troll farm" of proxy students who issue threats of legal action, specifically citing "Cyber Cell Tracking," as an intimidation tactic to force the deletion of honest, critical reviews.

FINANCIAL FRAUD AND REFUND EVASION

Users have reported losing significant sums—in some cases up to ₹2 Lakhs—on courses that were later claimed to be copied from other sources. When victims requested refunds, they were reportedly ghosted by support, blocked from student forums, or faced "bullying" from senior students to silence their complaints.

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THE 7-GENERATION MYTH & CAREER PIVOT

Devanshu Giri commonly claims a seven-generation lineage in astrology and Ayurveda, stating he was born into a Brahmin family descending from Maharishi Bhrigu. However, independent investigations and his own past statements suggest these claims may be heavily exaggerated.

Contradictory Backgrounds

While his marketing emphasizes a deep spiritual lineage, Giri has previously identified his father as an IIT engineer. In public forums, he once stated that his father and uncles were frequently "fooled" by astrologers during his childhood, leading his father to stop believing in astrological predictions.

Despite the "seven-generation" branding, Giri has admitted in forums

like Quora that he was entirely self-taught. He claimed he had no formal teacher for palmistry or astrology and originally viewed it as a hobby before monetizing it in 2018.

From Robotics to Astrology

Before founding Lunar Astro, Giri was an engineer specializing in Underwater Robotics. Critics point to this radical shift around 2017–18 as evidence that his astrological "lineage" is a marketing persona rather than a lifelong practice. Investigative reports allege Giri pivoted to astrology as a "zero-investment, high-return business" after failing to establish a stable career in robotic engineering and shipping.

The Accountability Gap

In robotics, Giri was strictly accountable; if an underwater robot failed, he wouldn't get paid. In

astrology, there is zero objective accountability. If a prediction fails, the blame is shifted to "bad karma" or

"wrong birth time," allowing for massive charging with zero liability.

"Mastering astrology takes decades. To start charging massive amounts in just 1-2 years, critics allege he took a shortcut by rebranding the work of his teacher to launch a premium brand instantly."

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PREMIUM MEDIOCRITY: THE PRICE-TO-VALUE GAP

For research into digital fraud, comparing Lunar Astro to established institutions highlights a massive "Price-to-Value" gap. While traditional Vedic schools focus on structured education at subsidized rates, Lunar Astro operates on a high-ticket, luxury marketing model designed for maximum profit.

INSTITUTION TYPE	COURSE / CONSULTATION COST	CREDENTIALS & TEACHING STAFF	MODEL & ACCOUNTABILITY
Traditional Schools (e.g., Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan)	Approx. ₹41,000 total for a 2-year path (Alankar + Acharya)	Taught by published authors and accomplished scholars.	Academic model with structured syllabus and standard exams.
Lunar Astro	₹1.5 to ₹2 Lakhs for courses; ₹10,000+ for consultations	Relies on Deepanshu Giri's personal branding; anonymous proxy students.	"Luxury" model using digital scarcity; zero objective accountability.
Independent Astrologers	₹1,000 to ₹3,000 per consultation	Highly experienced, local practitioners.	Direct 1-on-1 guidance and mentorship.

Unrecognized Certificates

Based on official records, Lunar Astro courses carry no formal academic certification or government recognition from bodies like the UGC, AICTE, or IGNOU. The "2-Year Online Certificate Course" is a private credential internal to the Lunar Astro Vedic Academy and has no official standing in the educational or professional regulatory system.

The Illusion of Success

While Lunar Astro's official sites are filled with success stories, there is a distinct lack of independent, high-profile graduates successful outside the Lunar Astro ecosystem. Most "successful" students are recruited back as panel astrologers operating under anonymous codes, preventing them from building independent professional reputations.

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PAGE 5 | CONSUMER PROTECTION GUIDE

HOW TO PROTECT YOURSELF

The rise of "GuruPreneurs" in the belief-based economy requires consumers to be highly vigilant. If you are seeking astrological or spiritual guidance, follow this checklist to protect yourself from predatory patterns and digital fraud.

CONSUMER RISK CHECKLIST

- **Avoid High-Value Prepayments:** Be extremely wary of paying large sums (e.g., ₹10,000 to ₹2 Lakhs) for consultations, "remedies," or courses upfront without verifiable guarantees.
- **Research Beyond Google:** Look for reviews on independent platforms (e.g., MouthShut, Reddit, independent forums) rather than relying solely on Google Reviews or YouTube comments, which are easily manipulated by troll farms and SEO tactics.
- **Verify Credentials:** Check if the institute is recognized by government educational bodies (like UGC or IGNOU). Private certificates often hold no professional weight.
- **Demand Transparency:** Ensure you know exactly who will be conducting your consultation. Do not accept "bait-and-switch" tactics where you pay for a master but receive an anonymous student.

TAKING ACTION

Initiate Chargebacks: Victims of bait-and-switch tactics or low-quality services report success by initiating chargebacks through their banks or credit card providers, citing "service not provided as described."

File Official Complaints: Use platforms like India's National Consumer Helpline (INGRAM) to file formal grievances against deceptive marketing and refund evasion.

Verify Corporate Claims: You can independently verify a company's financial health and legal standing using the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) portal. Check the Master Data for the Corporate Identification Number (CIN) and view public documents to cross-reference claimed profits against actual filed Balance Sheets.

Published for Educational and Awareness Purposes. Based on compiled investigative reports, consumer complaints, and public testimonies.

Always conduct independent research before making significant financial commitments in the belief-based economy.